

The Apple iPod

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Here is an account of my introduction to, interaction with, and finally introspection of the world's coolest personal music player. ☐

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A week after the Apple iPod Mini was launched in New York early this year, a grand total of 100,000 pieces were sold, easily making it one of the fastest selling gadgets of all time. iPod Zombies were just about everywhere. I hoped to the Lord Almighty that I would become a part of this exclusive club.

new crops up. How do I create folders in iPod? Hmm...

Day 1
The iPod arrived today. My wife's gift. I said: "Oh my god, it is whiter than I thought." I also had mixed emotions—I have the iPod, but it's the 15 GB version. Only 3,700 MP3s. But as they say, a Rolls Royce is a Rolls Royce, whether it is 10-ft long sedan or a 25-ft limousine. I gulped my gigabyte greed and accepted life. The 15 GB version costs \$300; a 20 GB comes at \$399, and a 40 GB even more. Can't afford it!

Day 10
Transferring my "huge" collection of 900 songs took me 23 minutes. Finally, the sound of success. I rotated the touch-pad dial. It gave me options, but I wanted to keep it simple—I just played the songs at random. I have heard good sound systems before, but the iPod takes the cake in personal entertainment.

Day 2
Today was "Impress your Friends and Colleagues Day". **The iPod made more news at office than Sonia Gandhi.** Thank you, Mr Andy Warhol; I got my 15 minutes of fame today. Even the big boss, who goes to San Francisco with the same nonchalance as others visit Bhopal, asked about it. The office walls looked green today.

Day 18
Tried creating folders again. Failure. How do I do it? Think. Think. Looked up Amazon. A whole new iPod industry has risen out of nowhere. Blogs, review sites, fan sites, assorted accessories, including the really cool **iTrip that converts your iPod into a local radio station.** How cool is that! It costs \$40. Someday, someday...

Day 4
Time to load existing songs into the iPod. First search for the USB cable. Damn! Wife did not buy the USB cable. **"The USB cable would have cost \$50 more."** Yikes! I had to search for a FireWire port to insert the FireWire cable. Finally found one. All I had to do was transfer songs to that laptop, and then listen at leisure. I will do it tomorrow.

Day 22
I had almost forgotten my iPod. I refused to let it out. What if it is endangered by accidental falls? The iPod has a hard disk, and can go kaput if it falls.

Day 5
The transfer from a Windows PC was not easy. When installing the iTunes software, I saw a Network Error dialog box. A network error? I continued. The install stopped in between. No dialog box this time. Remember King Bruce and the spider? Tried again. Success. iTunes installed.

Day 28
I revisited my iPod. Still pristine white. Look at the scratches. Sacrilege! Almost had a cardiac arrest. Never share the iPod. It also began skipping five seconds. I was scared. I used the Microsoft principle on an Apple product—restarted. It worked. God exists!

Day 7
I converted my audio CDs into the iTunes format. Complicated process. Something

Day 30
I finally figured out how to make folders. It was raining outside. Euro 2004 was on. Rain outside, live football inside, iPod music in my ears, and finger chips within reach. How's that for a state of male nirvana?